

March 2026

SPRING 2026 BIOLOGY FACULTY NEWSLETTER



OFFICE OF
UNDERGRADUATE
RESEARCH AND
INTERNSHIPS
FLORIDA INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY
DEPARTMENT OF BIOLOGICAL
SCIENCES

STUDENT HIGHLIGHT

30 FIU students proudly represented the university at the **Florida Undergraduate Research Conference** at the University of North Florida, where they showcased the innovative research they are conducting across disciplines. **Go Panthers, Go Research!**



FIU undergraduate researchers at the Florida Undergraduate Research Conference (FURC) hosted by the University of North Florida

Florida Undergraduate Research Leadership Summit (FURLS) was hosted at FIU for the first time, after traditionally being held at the University of Florida. In partnership with UF, FIU welcomed over **65 attendees** from 10 universities across Florida for the two-day summit on February 13–14, bringing together student leaders to strengthen undergraduate research initiatives across campuses. The event featured welcome remarks from Dean Ana Luszczynska and Amy Reid, and a keynote address by Dr. Angela Laird.



From left to right: Ismaray Govea, Amy Reid, Sabrina Alvarado, and Hannah Truong at the Florida Undergraduate Research Leadership Summit (FURLS) hosted at FIU

VOLUNTEER OPPORTUNITIES

7th OHBM Brain Mappers of Tomorrow

Please share with FIU students:
The 7th OHBM Brain Mappers of Tomorrow outreach program, an international initiative that introduces elementary and middle school students to neuroscience through interactive activities. Presenters and moderators will help deliver engaging classroom sessions that make brain science accessible and fun for young learners.



Scan to learn
more!
Apply by
April 3rd, 2026

For more info please contact: areid@fiu.edu

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH CONFERENCES AND EVENTS

Women in Science Seminar

Event will be held on Friday, **March 13th** from 9:00 AM – 1:00 PM in GC 355 | We encourage students to come! Everyone is welcome. | Featuring Keynote Speaker **Dr. Madelen Diaz**. | Open to all students. | RSVP via Panther Connect: <https://fiu.campuslabs.com/engage/event/12144616>

Undergraduate Research Conference at FIU (URFIU)

Encourage students to submit abstracts due by **March 13th** | Event will be held on Tuesday, April 7th – Wednesday, April 8th at FIU MMC Campus. | Registration is open till **April 6th** | Encourage your students to submit an abstract to present! | Register and submit your abstracts here: <https://researchconference.fiu.edu/>

Undergraduate Research Society

We invite faculty to encourage their students to join the Undergraduate Research Society (URS), where they can explore research opportunities and develop professional skills. URS supports students at every stage of their academic journey and helps foster confidence, leadership! **Join VIA Panther Connect:** <https://fiu.campuslabs.com/engage/organization/ustar>

FACULTY OPPORTUNITIES

Research Expo

Showcase your research opportunities at the Research Expo on **April 3, 2026**, from 9:00 AM to 2:00 PM in MARC 335 | The event will include research program tabling and a faculty speed mentor-matching session in collaboration with the Honors College | Interested in participating? Sign up: <https://forms.office.com/r/XsJvNubrNh>



FIU CEC faculty and program representatives connecting with students during Research Expo.

Summer Research Internship

Faculty are invited to serve as mentors in the **Summer Research Internship (SRI) Program**. Gaining the opportunity to guide undergraduate researchers will support student research development and engagement. Link to participate as an SRI mentor: https://fiu.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_6h4EYs5TAKuGqvs



From left to right: SRI 2025 alumni Melissa Gonzalez and mentor Dr. Matthew DeGennaro